

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

A collection of playing cards is shown. In the background, four cards are standing upright: King of Clubs, King of Diamonds, King of Spades, and Queen of Hearts. In the foreground, a fan of cards is laid out, showing from left to right: Queen of Clubs, 6 of Clubs, 3 of Clubs, Ace of Diamonds, 10 of Diamonds, 2 of Diamonds, Ace of Spades, 10 of Spades, 2 of Spades, Ace of Hearts, 8 of Hearts, and 2 of Hearts. A single red heart symbol is also visible at the bottom right.

Count Sure Winners				
				Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 4
 ♥ K 10 9 7 4 3
 ♦ A Q 7
 ♣ A 10

♠ A Q J 8 2

♥ A Q J 5

♦ J 6

♣ 7 4



♠ 9 3

♥ 8 2

♦ 10 9 5 4 2

♣ K 8 6 3

♠ K 10 7 5

♥ 6

♦ K 8 3

♣ Q J 9 5 2

West

1 ♥

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

North

1 ♠

4 ♠

East

Pass

South

2 ♥

[showcards W:H8 N:H6]

The bidding has been as shown. South's 2♥ bid shows good ♠ support with at least 10 points.

Partner led the ♥8, dummy played the ♥6

Play a small ♥.

Partner's ♥8 lead is a high spot card, either top-of-nothing, or a singleton or doubleton. He definitely does not have an honor, which means that North holds ♥ A Q J.

In other words, your ♥K is dead in the water. BUT, if you play it to this trick you hand North three ♥ tricks, while if you play a low ♥ he can only get 2 winners in the suit.

The extra winner would permit North to discard 2 of dummy's ♦ losers, and this would give North the contract.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 7 3
 ♥ 9 6 4
 ♦ K J 6
 ♣ K J 9 5

♠ J 9 8 5

♥ K 7

♦ 9 7 4 3

♣ 8 7 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ A Q 10 2

♣ Q 6 3

♠ Q 6 4

♥ Q J 10 5 3

♦ 8 5

♣ A 10 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

on the ♥Q, then again on trick two when you play the ♥K. AND HE WILL STILL HAVE HIS ♥A when you switch to another suit. He will have time to drive out the ♣A while he still has ♥s stopped.

It was a good thing you held the ♥K rather than declarer, but it is a nuisance that you must get out of the way on the very first trick.

[showcards W:HQ N:H4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥4

Play the ♥K.

Admittedly you have a terrible hand. But that's no reason to be careless. **YOU** can beat this contract, but you have to do it right now by unblocking the ♥K. If declarer holds up you will continue with your ♥7 and partner will establish his suit while he still has the ♣A for an entry. If declarer doesn't hold up it will be just as bad for him.

But suppose you say "Well, partner's ♥Q is just as good as my ♥K so I'll just save the King for later" as you play low. Declarer will love you. He will hold up ♥A when you switch to another suit. He will have time to drive out the ♣A while he still has ♥s stopped.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 3
♥ J 9 6 2
♦ A 7 3
♣ Q 10 8

♠ A Q J 10 7

♥ A 5

♦ K 4 2

♣ A J 2



♠ K 6 2

♥ K Q 3

♦ 10 9 8 5

♣ 9 7 3

♠ 5 4

♥ 10 8 7 4

♦ Q J 6

♣ K 6 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

Pass

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South